



A SPECIAL WEEK IN VIRAT'S COMPANY

Our correspondents bring you the highlights and **intriguing moments**, both on and off the field, from the last round of Ranji Trophy group-stage fixtures.

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For Delhi's Ranji Trophy players and support staff, the final group game from January 30 to February 1 at the Arun Jaitley Stadium will forever be etched in their memory. They secured an innings victory against Railways, but what made the match truly special — despite not making the knockouts — was the presence of Virat Kohli in the Delhi dressing room after more than 12 years.

Team manager Mahesh Bhati, who also managed Delhi's one-day squad when the 36-year-old last played for the State in 2012, shed

light on what it was like to have Kohli in their midst.

"So many of the current players hadn't played with him. It was a great experience, particularly for them. (Navdeep) Saini has played with him for India, and (Ayush) Badoni has faced him in the IPL, but nobody would have got to spend so much time with him. It was very beneficial for all the boys. Inside the dressing room, Virat shared his experiences," said Bhati.

During the two days of practice before the game, Kohli was often seen chatting with Bhati, their association dating back to 2006 when Bhati was Delhi Under-19 coach and Kohli was rising through



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